and T, I selected two different letters in the alphabet from which to form the sample of stocks. Again, over a five-year time frame, but with a different starting and a different closing date, the degree of variation was almost exactly the same.

Looking back on most markets of five-year duration, I believe that one can find stock performance results that are about as disparate. Some of this dispersion may come as the result of surprises—important new information about a stock's prospects that could not be reasonably fore-seen at the outset of the period. Most of the differences, however, can be anticipated at least roughly both in terms of direction and general magnitude of gains and losses relative to the market.